

Solar PLI scheme to get additional funding

During her Budget speech, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said that the government has proposed increasing the Production Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme for domestic solar cells and module manufacturing to ₹240 billion from the existing

construction of the new unit. Apart from the main factory unit, a plan for on-site housing of all employees may also be approved.

MeitY invites applications for financial support to Indian firms to make chips

MeitY has invited applications for providing financial support to

Centre notifies drone certification scheme and bans import of drones

The government has notified drone certification scheme to ensure minimum safety and quality and make certification of drones simpler, faster, and transparent. The manufacturer, while applying for certification of a drone, will have to submit various data and test results on topics such as weight, type of launch and recovery mechanism installed, speed, range, endurance, battery performance, and type of material used in construction. Additionally, the Centre has put a ban on the import of drones with immediate effect. The Ministry of Civil Aviation said that while exceptions were provided for R&D, defense, and security, importing drones for these purposes will require due clearances.

Phased manufacturing plan to promote indigenous manufacture of EVs

The Ministry of Heavy Industries has notified a phased manufacturing programme (PMP) to promote indigenous manufacturing of EVs, its assemblies/sub-assemblies and parts/sub-parts/inputs of the sub-assemblies. GST on EVs has also been reduced from 12% to 5%; GST on chargers/charging stations for EVs has been reduced from 18% to 5%.

IT Hardware PLI: India saw production worth ₹672.75 billion in 2021

The Economic Survey of 2021-22 presented by Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman revealed that India saw production worth ₹672.75 billion under Production Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme for large-scale electronics. The country saw an investment of ₹25.95 billion and production worth ₹672.75 billion under the PLI scheme, out of which, ₹205.68 billion worth of products were exported till June 2021.

Engineering goods exports grew by 54% YoY in Jan-Apr 2021

Engineering goods exports surged to \$81.8 billion during April-December 2021 as compared to \$52.9 billion



Representational image

₹45 billion to make India an exporting nation, outlining an additional ₹195 billion to the scheme.

India Semiconductor Mission looking for CXOs

The India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) is looking for a Chief Executive Officer (CEO), Chief Financial Officer (CFO), and Chief Technical Officer (CTO). To apply for the CEO position, one must have at least 25 years of semiconductor industry experience, which should include 10+ years of experience at the global level.

India's first fab unit likely by 2024

India's first fabrication unit is likely to be set up by 2024 as the government targets to approve the application of at least one big global semiconductor fabrication company before March 31. As per a report, the ministry plans to give the winning bidder 700-750 days to allow the

domestic companies to set up shop for chip manufacturing. Proposals have been invited from Indian companies with indigenous technologies at commercialisation stage in semiconductor and sensor domain focusing on semiconductor fabrication, display fabrication, designing for ICs, chipsets, SoCs, and so on. Last date to submit the proposal is March 26, 2022.

MeitY releases 5-year vision chart to grow electronics manufacturing

The government has released a 5-year roadmap and vision document to grow electronics manufacturing and exports into a \$300 billion market by 2026. The report provides a year-wise break-up and production projections for various products. It also seeks a competitive tariff structure for electronic components and removal of all regulatory uncertainty.